

Refund Policy & Refund Processing Manual

Version

1.0

Purpose

This manual provides customer support representatives with standardized procedures for handling refund requests. It explains eligibility criteria, verification steps, refund methods, processing timelines, troubleshooting, and escalation guidelines to ensure a smooth and transparent refund experience.

1. Introduction

Refund requests are a common part of customer support. Customers may request refunds due to damaged products, incorrect deliveries, duplicate payments, cancelled orders, defective items, or service failures.

Support agents should carefully verify customer information, follow company refund policies, and communicate expected timelines clearly.

2. Common Refund Requests

Customers typically request refunds for the following reasons:

- Product received is damaged
- Wrong product delivered
- Duplicate payment
- Order cancelled before shipment
- Defective product
- Service not delivered
- Missing items in the package
- Payment deducted but order not confirmed

Identifying the correct refund category helps determine the appropriate resolution.

3. Customer Verification

Before initiating any refund, verify the customer's identity and purchase details.

Required Information

- Customer Name
- Order ID
- Registered Email Address
- Mobile Number
- Payment Reference Number
- Date of Purchase

Verification Checklist

- ✓ Customer identity verified
 - ✓ Order details confirmed
 - ✓ Payment successfully validated
 - ✓ Refund eligibility checked
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4. Refund Eligibility

Customers are eligible for refunds under the following conditions:

- Product received damaged
- Incorrect item delivered
- Order cancelled before shipping
- Duplicate payment confirmed
- Product returned within the return window
- Service could not be provided

Refunds may not be approved for:

- Physical damage caused by the customer
- Expired return period

- Missing accessories or original packaging (where applicable)
 - Violation of company return policy
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5. Refund Processing Procedure

Step 1

Receive the refund request.

Step 2

Verify customer identity.

Step 3

Validate the Order ID.

Step 4

Confirm payment status.

Step 5

Check refund eligibility.

Step 6

Create a refund request in the support system.

Step 7

Inform the customer of the expected refund timeline.

Step 8

Monitor refund completion until successfully processed.

6. Refund Methods

Refunds are generally processed using the customer's original payment method.

Payment Method Refund Destination

Credit Card	Original Card
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Payment Method Refund Destination

Debit Card	Original Card
UPI	Same UPI ID
Net Banking	Bank Account
Digital Wallet	Wallet Balance

Agents should never request confidential banking passwords or OTPs.

7. Refund Processing Timeline

Payment Method Expected Processing Time

UPI	1–3 Business Days
Credit Card	5–7 Business Days
Debit Card	5–7 Business Days
Net Banking	3–5 Business Days
Digital Wallet	1–2 Business Days

Customers should be informed that bank processing times may vary.

8. Troubleshooting Refund Issues

Refund Not Received

Possible Causes:

- Bank processing delay
- Incorrect account details
- Pending financial verification

Resolution:

- Check refund status in the system

- Verify payment reference
 - Advise customer to wait for the standard processing period
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Duplicate Refund Request

Resolution:

- Verify if an existing refund request already exists
 - Inform customer of the current status
 - Avoid creating duplicate refund tickets
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Refund Rejected

Possible Reasons:

- Refund policy violation
- Return window expired
- Product inspection failed

Resolution:

Explain the reason politely and provide alternative support if available.

9. Escalation Guidelines

Escalate the refund request if:

- High-value refund exceeds approval limit
- Payment gateway failure
- Multiple failed refund attempts
- Customer disputes the refund decision
- Suspected fraudulent activity

Escalation Team

Finance Operations Team

Priority Level:

High

10. Sample Customer Conversation

Customer

"I cancelled my order three days ago, but I haven't received my refund."

Support Agent

"I understand your concern. Let me verify your order and refund status."

(After verification)

"Your refund has already been initiated and is currently being processed by your bank. It should reflect in your account within the next 3 to 5 business days."

Customer

"Thank you."

Support Agent

"You're welcome. If the refund is not received within the expected timeframe, please contact us again with your Order ID."

11. Service Level Agreement (SLA)

Activity	Target Time
Customer Verification	3 Minutes
Refund Eligibility Check	5 Minutes
Refund Request Creation	3 Minutes
Escalation (if required)	10 Minutes
Complete Refund Processing As per Payment Method	

12. Best Practices for Support Agents

- Verify customer identity before processing refunds.
 - Clearly explain refund eligibility.
 - Communicate expected processing timelines.
 - Avoid making promises beyond company policy.
 - Record all refund requests accurately.
 - Escalate financial issues promptly.
 - Maintain professionalism and empathy throughout the interaction.
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13. Summary

A well-defined refund process improves customer satisfaction and builds trust. Support agents should follow verification procedures, apply refund policies consistently, communicate timelines clearly, and escalate exceptional cases when necessary. Proper documentation and transparent communication help ensure smooth refund processing while maintaining company standards.